

Short version:

LLMs can *explain* car buying. They shouldn't be the ones to *commit* to anything that involves money, risk, or accountability.

Here's what they **won't really give customers** about buying a car (even as they get crazy good):

1. A *binding* out-the-door number

An LLM can *estimate*:

- Payments
- Taxes & fees
- "Rough" out-the-door prices

But it **can't**:

- Lock a VIN-specific, contract-ready OTD price
- Guarantee that number will still be good tomorrow
- Take legal responsibility if something changes

Anything that turns into, "Sign here and we're on the hook," has to come from the dealer's actual systems and people, not a probabilistic model.

2. Real underwriting or credit decisions

Even if it's integrated with tools, the LLM itself is not the lender.

It can't truly:

- Pull and interpret your real credit file on its own authority
- Approve or deny a loan

- Promise a rate or term the bank must honor

It can *explain* how credit works. It cannot be the one **taking risk**.

3. A guaranteed trade value

LLMs can talk about:

- How trade values are calculated
- Typical ranges based on year/miles/condition

They can't:

- See/smell/hear the car
- Catch prior accident work or reconditioning costs
- Actually *commit* the store to a guaranteed "we'll cut you this check" number

That always requires a human + physical inspection + store authority.

4. Physical experience and gut feel

They can't give the customer:

- What it feels like to sit in the seat with the wheel in your hands
- Whether a 3rd-row actually works for their kids
- Noise, ride quality, "does this feel like *me*?"

LLMs can describe those things. They can't replace a test drive or that "this is the one" moment.

5. Real accountability if things go sideways

An LLM:

- Can apologize
- Can “own” a mistake in text

But it cannot:

- Pay for a misquote
- Fix a blown delivery date
- Comp you a service visit or discount to make something right

Customers ultimately need a **person and an organization** that can say, “Yep, that’s on us. Here’s how we’ll fix it.”

6. Perfect, real-time store reality

Even with great integrations, there are hard edges:

- Last-unit inventory (car just sold 5 minutes ago)
- Micro-incentives changing this morning
- Manager-specific deals (“I’ll do this for you if you take delivery today”)

LLMs are always working from **data that’s a snapshot**, not the actual, messy, political reality of a store on a Saturday afternoon.

7. True advocacy and relationship

They can simulate empathy, but they cannot:

- Actually care if this payment stretches your budget
- Remember your kid’s name and follow up in three years because they *want* to

- Build a relationship that feels like, “I’ve got a person at that store”

For most people, a car is a big, emotional purchase. A relationship outlives any chat.

8. Power inside the dealership

LLMs don’t have:

- Authority to lean on service for a faster appointment
- Influence with the GM or GSM
- The ability to call in a favor or say, “Let me talk to my manager, I’ll fight for this.”

They can suggest what *should* happen. They can’t make people do it.

9. Judgment calls on edge cases

LLMs struggle (and *should* be limited) around:

- Weird title situations (divorce, estate, out-of-state issues)
- Messy credit stories (“I had a repo, then a BK, and I just started my job...”)
- Ethical lines (“Should I roll this negative equity into another 84-month loan?”)

You don’t want a model making **moral** or **life impact** calls. That’s human territory.

10. The feeling of safety when money is on the line

They can reduce confusion, but they can’t give:

- The reassurance of, “You’re all set. This is exactly what’s happening next.”
- The confidence that someone who knows the store, the lenders, and *you* is watching your deal.

That sense of “you’re safe in this process” comes from **transparent systems + accountable humans**, not the LLM alone.

If you want a simple line you can use with dealers:

“LLMs are for clarity. Humans are for commitments and consequences.”

That’s the gap where a company like Strolid lives:

Let the LLM handle the explaining, searching, and prepping — then bring in humans (and real dealer systems) for prices, credit, trades, risk, and relationships.